

Google Day @ IISc: Digital Poster Presentation Guidelines & Template

1. Overview & Key Dates

Google is hosting a premier **PhD & Research Poster Presentation Competition** at IISc Bengaluru on **September 18, 2026**.

All selected finalists will receive **complimentary on-site professional printing (on premium matte fabric) and board mounting** sponsored by Google via our event production partner.

- **Participation Eligibility:** Doctoral (PhD) & M.Tech (Research) Scholars across **CSA, CDS, ECE, EE, ESE, and CPS** departments at IISc.
- **Submission Deliverable:** Single-page **PDF** of your digital poster draft, **short text abstract** (200 words) & artifact links (optional but encouraged)
- **Submission Deadline:** **September 06, 2026 (02:00 PM IST)**.
- **On-Day Session:** September 18, 2026 | 12:00 PM – 01:30 PM IST
- **Incentives:**
 - Official Google Research Commendation Certificate & Trophy
 - Direct 1:1 Mentorship session with Google Researchers
 - Dedicated conversations with Google recruiters to explore internship/FTE opportunities
 - Google Swags

2. Eligible Research Tracks & Focus Areas

Submissions must align with one of the following priority research tracks:

- **Track 1: Core AI/ML & Trustworthy Systems**
 - **Foundational Models:** Large Language Models (LLMs), Vision-Language Models (VLMs), Multimodal Learning
 - **Efficient ML & Optimization:** PEFT, LoRA, Quantization, Distillation, On-Device / Edge ML
 - **Theory & Algorithms:** Reinforcement Learning, Optimization, Mathematical Foundations of Deep Learning
 - **Trustworthy AI:** Model Interpretability, Robustness, Hallucination Mitigation, Fairness & AI Safety
- **Track 2: Distributed Systems, Networking & Cloud Infrastructure**
 - **Distributed Computing & ML Systems:** Distributed Training, Large-Scale Inference Optimization, ML Compilers & Frameworks
 - **Networking & Cloud:** Datacenter / Cloud Networking, High-Performance Interconnects, Scalable Cloud Architectures
 - **High-Performance Computing (HPC):** Parallel Algorithms, Large-Scale Storage, Security & Privacy in Distributed Systems
- **Track 3: Hardware Architecture, Silicon & Edge Systems**
 - **Silicon & Compute:** Hardware Accelerators (TPUs/GPUs/ASICs), Computer Architecture, Memory Subsystems & Interconnects
 - **Edge & Embedded AI:** Low-Power Architectures, Edge Silicon, Embedded ML

- **Autonomous & Cyber-Physical Systems:** Robotics, Autonomous Systems, Sensor Networks & Physical Computing
- **AI assisted CAD/Si Design**

3. Mandatory Print & File Specifications

Specification	Requirement	Recommended Best Practices
Dimensions	A0 Portrait (841 mm × 1189 mm / 33.1 in × 46.8 in) OR 36 in × 48 in Portrait	Vertical orientation is mandatory to fit exhibition easels.
File Format	Single-page Vector PDF (.pdf)	Ensure all fonts are embedded upon export.
Resolution	300 DPI at 100% scale	Prevents pixelation and artifacts during fabric printing.
Color Space	CMYK (Preferred) or sRGB	Use a high-contrast light/white background.
Safe Margins	Minimum 25 mm (1.0 inch)	Keep all critical text/figures inside safe margins.
Naming Convention	[DEPT]_[StudentName]_[ShortTitle].pdf	Example: CSA_AnanyaSharma_EfficientLLMInference.pdf

4. Recommended Poster Structure & Content Breakdown

A 3-column vertical layout provides optimal narrative flow and visual balance:

Header Section

- **Title:** Concise, impactful title summarizing the technical breakthrough.
- **Author Info:** Presenting student name (underlined), co-authors, PhD advisor(s), Lab name, Department (CSA/CDS/ECE/EE/ESE/CPS), and IISc affiliation.
- **Track Banner:** Explicitly list your submitted research track.

Column 1: Context, Motivation & Problem Statement

- **Motivation:** Why is this problem significant to academia and industry?
- **Limitations of Prior SOTA:** Why do existing approaches fail or scale poorly (e.g., compute bottlenecks, high latency, distribution shift)?
- **Core Hypothesis / Thesis:** What is your key technical proposition?

Column 2: Proposed Methodology & System Architecture (Visual Anchor)

- **System Architecture / Pipeline Diagram:** High-resolution vector schematic of your model, algorithm, or hardware design.
- **Algorithmic Novelty:** 2–3 concise bullets on mathematical formulations or architectural breakthroughs.

Column 3: Empirical Validation, Scalability & Artifacts

- **Benchmark Results:** 1–2 clean tables or charts comparing performance against SOTA baselines (latency, accuracy, speedup, memory footprint).
- **Critical Analysis & Trade-offs:** Key takeaways, efficiency gains, and failure mode analysis.
- **Real-World Impact & Scalability:** Practical deployment path (cloud, edge, healthcare, agriculture, Indic NLP).
- **QR Code & References:** Scannable QR code linking to preprint (arXiv), GitHub repository, or interactive demo.

5. Typography Hierarchy & Font Family Options

Posters must be clearly legible from 1.5 to 2.0 meters (5–6 feet) away:

Hierarchy Level	Recommended Size (A0)	Style / Weight
Poster Title	72 – 90 pt	Bold / Heavy (700/800)
Section Headings	36 – 48 pt	Bold / Colored accent (700)
Subheadings & Highlights	28 – 32 pt	Medium / Semi-bold (500/600)
Body Text & Bullets	22 – 26 pt	Regular (Minimum readable size: 20 pt)
Captions & References	16 – 20 pt	Regular / Italic

Recommended Font Options by Tool / Platform

If **Google Sans** is not installed, use any of the following freely available or system-standard typefaces:

1. **Free / Web Fonts (Google Fonts, Google Slides, Canva, Keynote):**
 - **Roboto / Roboto Flex (Top Recommendation):** Google's primary open-source typeface with clean geometry and excellent numeral clarity.
 - **Inter:** Engineered specifically for dense technical/scientific UI and high-DPI displays.
 - **Open Sans / Lato:** Neutral, friendly, and highly legible at large scales.
 - **Montserrat / Poppins:** Excellent bold choices for poster titles and section headers.
2. **Standard System Fonts (Windows, macOS, Linux / PowerPoint):**
 - **Arial / Arial Black:** Universally available across all OS platforms; guaranteed zero font-rendering bugs at print.
 - **Helvetica / Helvetica Neue:** The global gold standard for academic and scientific conference posters.
 - **Calibri / Segoe UI (Windows):** Clean, modern humanist sans-serif.
 - **San Francisco / SF Pro (macOS):** Clean system default for Mac Keynote.

3. LaTeX / Overleaf Packages (for **beamerposter** / **tikz** users):

- `\usepackage[sfdefault]{roboto}` — Full Roboto font family.
 - `\usepackage{inter}` — Inter sans-serif font.
 - `\usepackage{helvet}` with `\renewcommand{\familydefault}{\sfdefault}` — Helvetica.
 - `\usepackage{sourcesanspro}` — Adobe Source Sans 3 / Source Sans Pro.
 - `\usepackage{lmodern}` with `\sffamily` — Latin Modern Sans.
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6. How to Set Up Your Poster in Popular Tools

In Google Slides / Microsoft PowerPoint

1. Navigate to **File > Page Setup > Custom**.
 2. Enter **84.1 cm × 118.9 cm** (or **33.1 in × 46.8 in**).
 3. Set orientation to **Portrait**.
 4. Use 3 guideline columns (**View > Guides**).
 5. When complete, export via **File > Download > PDF Document (.pdf)**.
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7. Shortlisting Rubric

Google Technical Review Committee members will evaluate submissions on the following 4 dimensions:

1. **Technical Depth & Innovation (30%):** Originality and depth of the theoretical, algorithmic, or architectural contribution over SOTA.
 2. **Experimental Rigor & Validation (25%):** Strength of baseline comparisons, dataset breadth, and quantifiable gains.
 3. **Poster Design & Visual Hierarchy (20%):** Clean structure, high-quality vector diagrams, and avoidance of dense text walls.
 4. **Industry Scalability & Impact (25%):** Real-world applicability, societal value, and availability of open-source artifacts/links.
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8. Final Pre-Submission Checklist for Students

- ☐ **Dimensions:** Exactly A0 Portrait (841 × 1189 mm) or 36" × 48" Portrait.
- ☐ **Typography:** Body text is 22 pt font size and readable from 5–6 feet.
- ☐ **Graphics:** Model/pipeline architecture diagram is vector/high-resolution.
- ☐ **Charts:** Benchmark axes have clear labels, units, and high-contrast legends.
- ☐ **QR Code:** Tested on mobile devices and directed to paper, preprint, or GitHub repo.
- ☐ **File Name:** Formatted as `[DEPT]_[StudentName]_[ShortTitle].pdf`.